
The RealReal
Conversational Shopping
Q3 2026

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Conversational Shopping Overview

Problem

Discovery Learning Curve

Keyword search only works if customers know exactly what to type—and how our inventory is described. Most don't.

Opportunity

From Keywords to Dialogue

Google's shopping agent turns keyword search into a natural conversation, helping users find the right products without having to know the exact words to search.

Users can discover products, compare options, and get styling guidance in one flow.

Opportunity

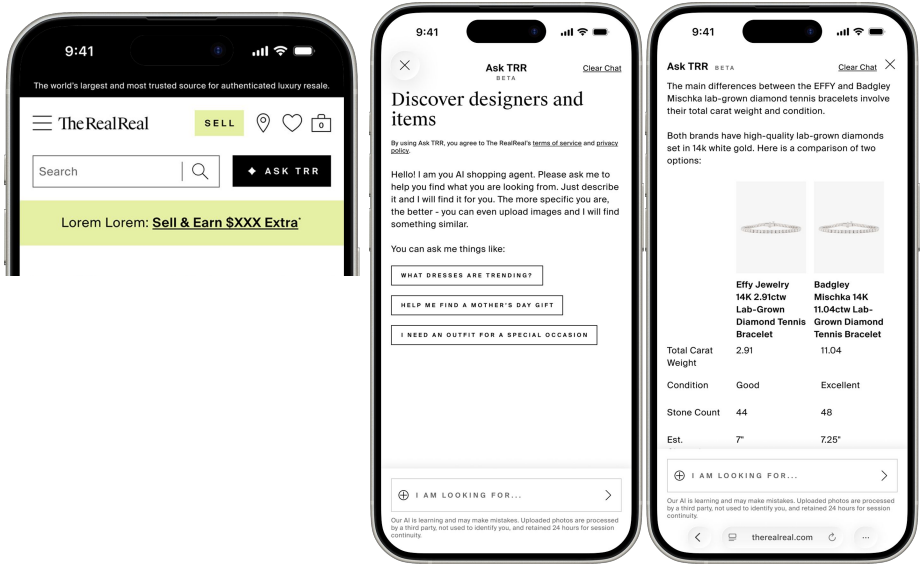
$30M+

Annual GMV Potential

Inventory

3M+

In Stock Items



Who We're Designing For

🆕 New Buyers

Challenges

Unfamiliarity with buying secondhand. Limited understanding of fashion attributes and effective search terms.

Hypothesis

Gaps in discovery ease, trust drive high bounce.

💰 Key KPIs

New CVR, % Active Buyer Growth

🔁 Repeat Buyers

Challenges

Shipping fees deter single-item orders & manual merch-driven outfitting not scalable.

Hypothesis

Agentic styling suggestions increase basket size.

💰 Key KPIs

Units per transaction, Orders, AOV, GMV/visitor

🆕🔁 Both

Challenges

Decision fatigue & limited buying confidence.

Hypothesis

Product comparison & AI decision guidance drives conversion.

💰 Key KPIs

CVR, LTV

MOST-LIKELY USERS

Early AI Adopters — Convenience Maximizers who are used to shopping with AI / algorithmic recommendations

Strategy

Intuition Prove the agent's out-of-the-box discovery capabilities first, then expand into contextual entry points and selling, CS/CR use cases.

MVP

Discovery

CORE CAPABILITIES

- Image, semantic search
- Guided refinement via dialogue
- Product comparison + outfitting

ROLLOUT PLAN

- All customers (beta)
- In-app modal for feedback

Validate ATC, CVR, AOV, and GMV improvements.

P2

Placement & Cases

CORE CAPABILITIES

- Contextual PDP prompts
- CS / CR Questions
- Selling Q&A
- Feed-like discovery

GOAL

Contextual: right moment, right message.

Habit-formation.



P3

Transactions

CORE CAPABILITIES

- Buying: Checkout within agent
- Used saved payment methods

GOAL

Validate that enabling purchase within agent improves conversion.



User Journey #1: Discover

01. Input

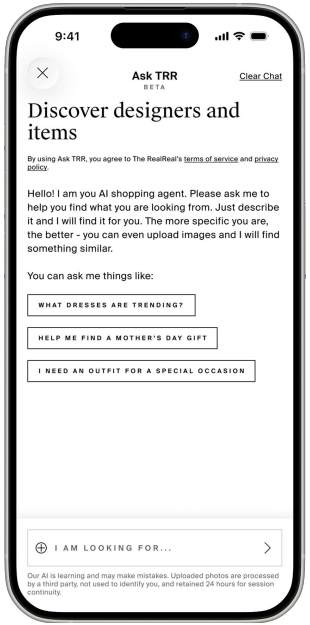
PROMPT

"*Dresses for a summer wedding in Napa*"

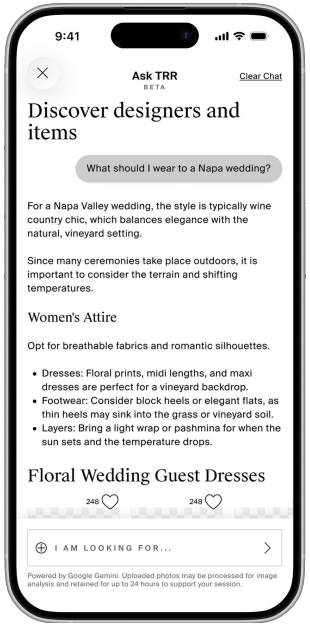
PHOTO



02. Search



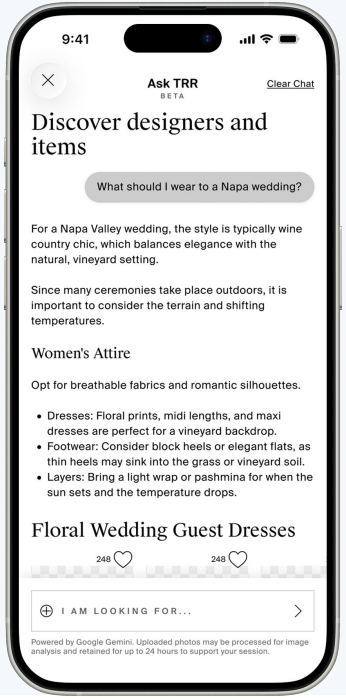
03. Results & Refinement



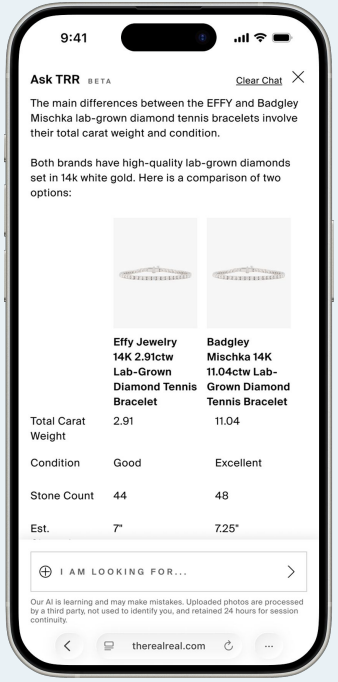
Primary Metrics: PDP CTR • Search engagement • Add to Cart / Obsessions

User Journey #2: Compare & Decide

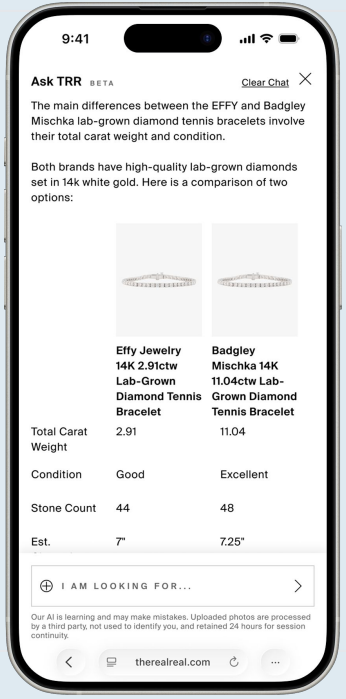
1. Results



2. Comparison



3. Decision



Primary Metrics: CVR • Basket Size • Add to Cart / Obsessions

North Star

From ➔	To
Entering precise keywords to find what you want.	**Starting with an image, a half-baked idea, occasion/trend—no exact wording needed.**
Performing back-to-back searches; too much specificity yields null results.	**Agents understand intent. Relevant results on the first try.**
Applying rigid attribute filters to narrow results.	**Guided discovery; refining results through simple back-and-forth dialogue.**
Endlessly scrolling through ~100s of items in search without converting	**Agent ranks and shows most relevant handful of items first with optionality to see more**
Comparing products by opening multiple browser tabs and scanning PDP details.	**Agent highlights key differences side-by-side and guides your decision.**
Recent searches	**Entirety of conversational history and context to pick up where you left off**
Users manually pull together outfits or use external tools for inspiration.	**TRR's agent gives styling advice and outfitting recommendations, helping users build complete looks and increase basket size.**

Things to Consider

Our operational model creates distinct considerations for AI agent recommendations and inventory management:

Single SKU Inventory

Unique Item Stock: 1 quantity in stock per item. Once sold, it's gone.

Variable PDPs: Nearly identical items are processed separately with unique metadata.

What This Means:

- Don’t show sold / on hold products in results.
- AI sees items as unique; "constant cold start" due to meta-data differences.

Cart Holds & State

20-Minute Window: Adding to bag triggers a 20-minute timer to reserve the item. Only one user can hold an item at a time.

What This Means:

- Results must show real-time status (Sold, On Hold).
- The agent must navigate users around "On Hold" items to avoid checkout frustration.

Phase 1 - July 30th

Users can search and compare items in the agent, then click into PDPs to view full product details, obsess, and buy.

In Scope

- Major platforms (Desktop, mWeb, and iOS)
- Natural language and image search
- Filtering
- Side-by-side comparison
- Product clicks
- Styling recommendations
- Add to Cart within agent
- User feedback survey

Out of Scope

- Obsessing within the agent *(fast follow)*
- First Look
- Checkout
- Multi-currency

Rollout Plan

Problem

Search only works if you can perfectly describe the items you want.

Hypothesis

An agent will improve discoverability by allowing users to search in their own words, compare items, and ask for styling tips.

Experiment Start

Aug 24th at 5% traffic

Platform

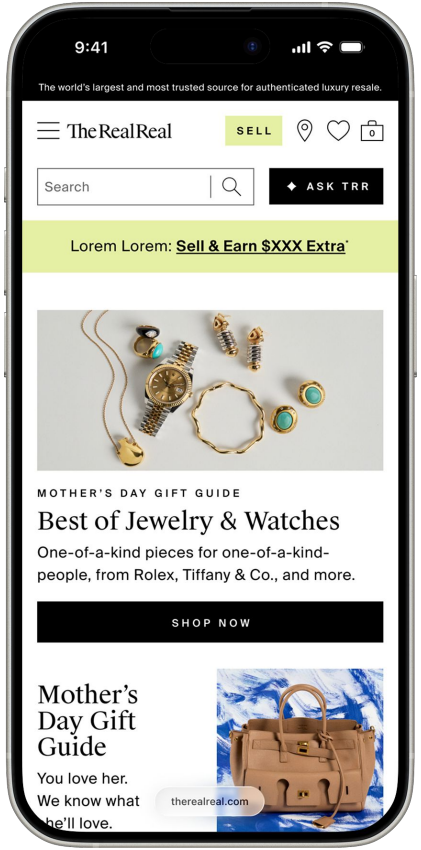
All

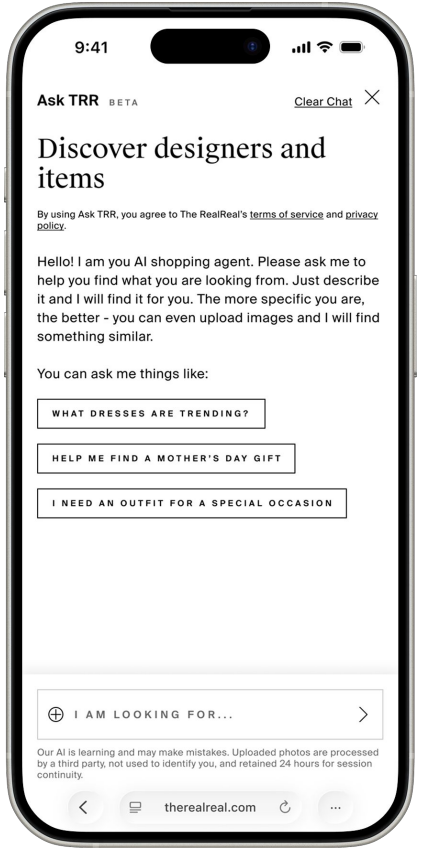
Success

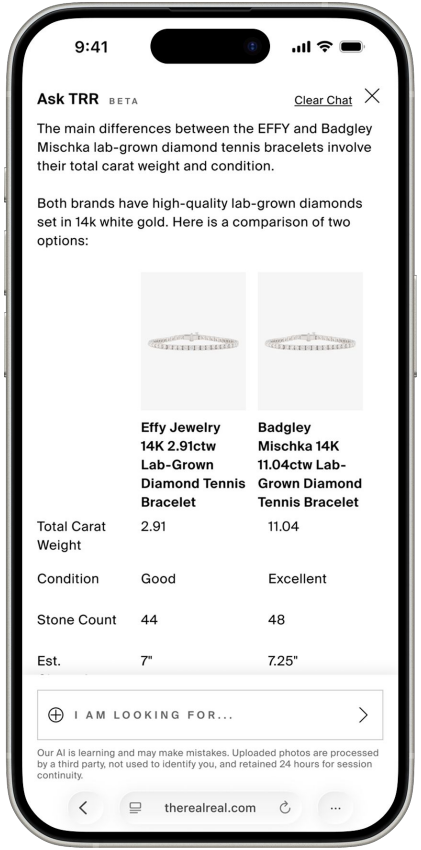
Obsessions ↑, Add to Cart ↑

Downstream

Visitor Conversion ↑, GMV per visitor ↑







Analysis & Learning

Survey

Capture how users perceive and evaluate the experience.

Conversational Summary

Leveraging LLMs to summarize conversations and reveal customer intent, unmet needs, and gaps.

Rollout

Measure whether the experience drives engagement and conversion.

Feedback Loop

We share learnings with Google to improve relevance and model performance.

Framework

How the Pieces Fit Together:

Qualitative: Survey and LLM summary uncover hidden user intent and explicit needs.

Quantitative: Behavioral metrics track impact.

Optimization: Google loops feed learnings back into the discovery system continuously.

2. MVP

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Capabilities - Discovery

Objective: Find the right product, get styling / outfitting suggestions, evaluate products side-by-side.

Area	Capability	End User
Entry + Input	Ability to easily discover across platforms (desktop, mWeb, iOS)	Buyer
	Ability to search by entering natural language or uploading an image	Buyer
	Ability to see education & prompts to get you started	Buyer / Merch
Guided Discovery	Ability to ask follow-up questions to narrow results	Buyer
	Ability to understand why results are shown	Buyer
	Ability to ask for outfitting and styling recommendations based on results	Buyer
	Ability to compare multiple products on different attributes (esp. Condition)	Buyer
	Ability to see information about promo codes, MSRP, discounts	Buyer
	Ability to reset, clear a conversation	Buyer

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Internal User Capabilities - Discovery

Objective: Capture intent and drive efficient product discovery

Area	Capability	End User
Relevance + Quality	Ability to understand search queries and map user intent to catalog of 2M+ items	Google Eng
	Ability to retrieve + rank relevant products based on a revenue-maximizing model	Google Eng
	Ability to gracefully handle zero results; questions about selling	Google Eng
	Ability to learn from implicit user signals and improve the agent over time	Google Eng
	Ability to suggest outfits and compare products	Google Eng
Trust + Safety	Ability to serve fallback responses for unknown/restricted/out of scope queries	Google Eng
	Ability to limit or prevent hallucinations	Google Eng
	Ability to portray products accurately, within guardrails and not conflicting with PDP.	Google Eng
Measurement	Full funnel tracking (entry → engagement → PDP click)	PM
	Ability to track sales value (AOV, ASP, GMV)	PM / Merch
	Ability to see Amplitude session replays of users interacting with conversational search	PM / UX Design

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Capabilities - Transact

Objective: Seamlessly transact

Area	Capability	End User
Transactions	Ability to add to cart & transact from search results within the agent window via natural language	Buyer
	Ability to view, edit cart within agent	Buyer
	Ability to enter shipping, payment info, see est. delivery	Buyer
	Ability to get an order confirmation message within the window	Buyer
	Ability to enter promo codes, see payment decline	Buyer
Validation	Ability to use saved addresses, payment methods, frictionless checkout	Buyer
	Ability to display cart timer / time remaining for items in cart	Buyer
	Ability to calculate total cost (tax, shipping, fees) prior to payment	Buyer
	Ability to validate shipping address and eligibility	Buyer
	Ability to re-add item if hold expires	Buyer
	Ability to retry payment or select alternate payment methods	Buyer

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Internal User Capabilities: Transact

Objective: Seamlessly buy

Area	Capability	End User
Transactions	Ability to complete checkout via natural language inputs	Google Eng
	Ability to confirm or clarify key steps (address, shipping speed, payment)	Google Eng
	Ability to serve explanations for issues (e.g., payment decline, cart expiration)	Google Eng
Tracking	Ability to track end-to-end funnel (search → add to cart → checkout → purchase)	PM
	Ability to identify drop-off points (cart, checkout, payment)	PM
	Ability to track gross merchandise value (GMV)	PM

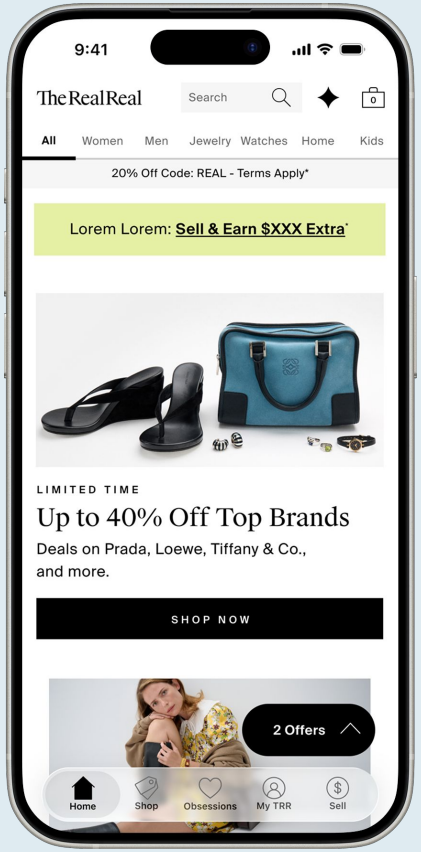
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3. Designs

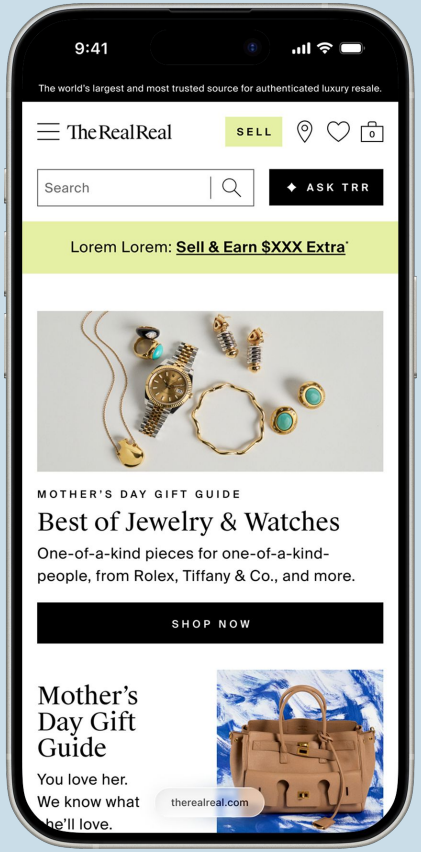
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Entry Point

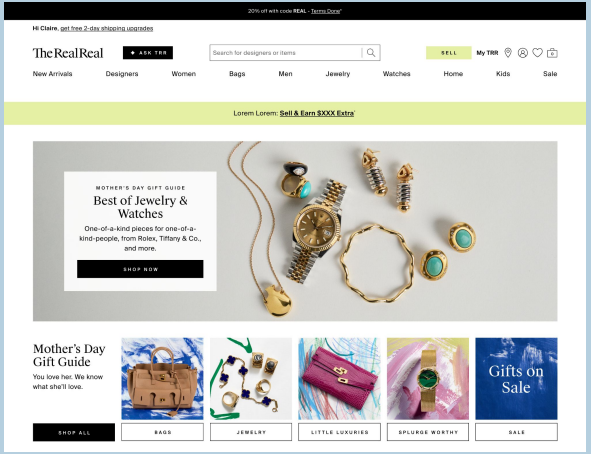
Native



Mobile Web

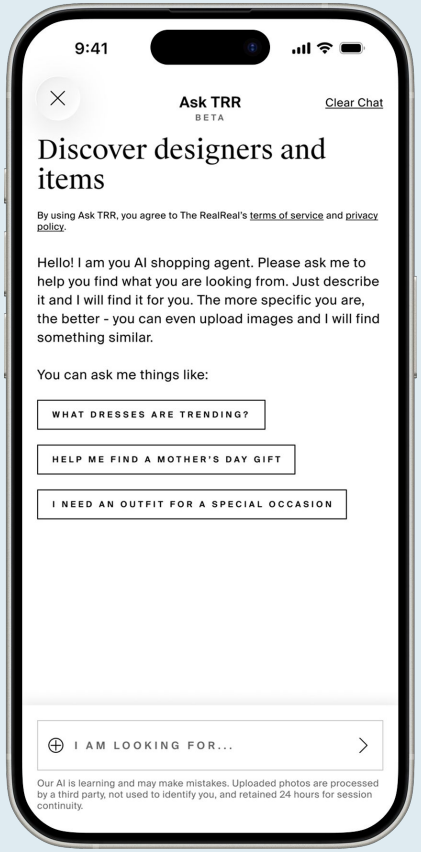


Desktop

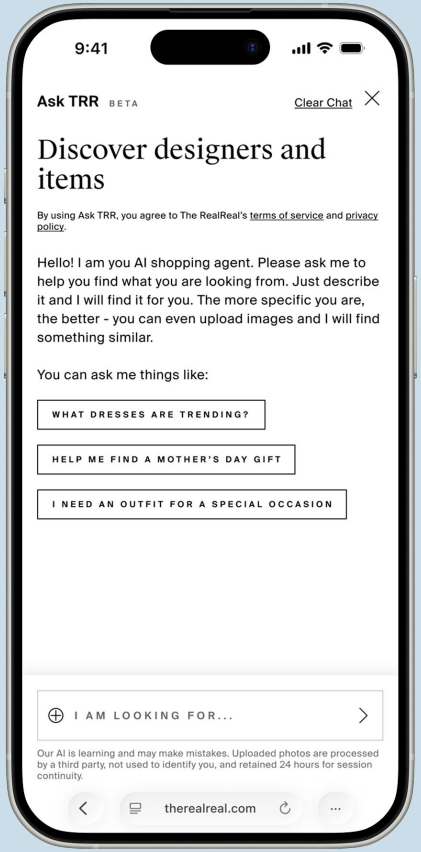


1st Time User

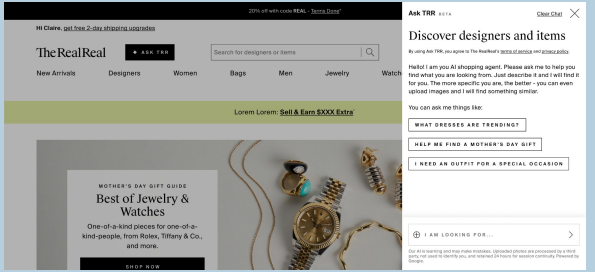
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Mobile Web

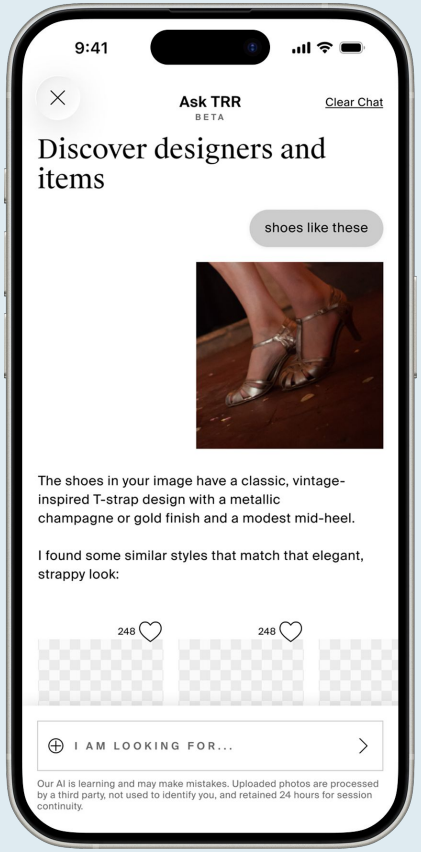


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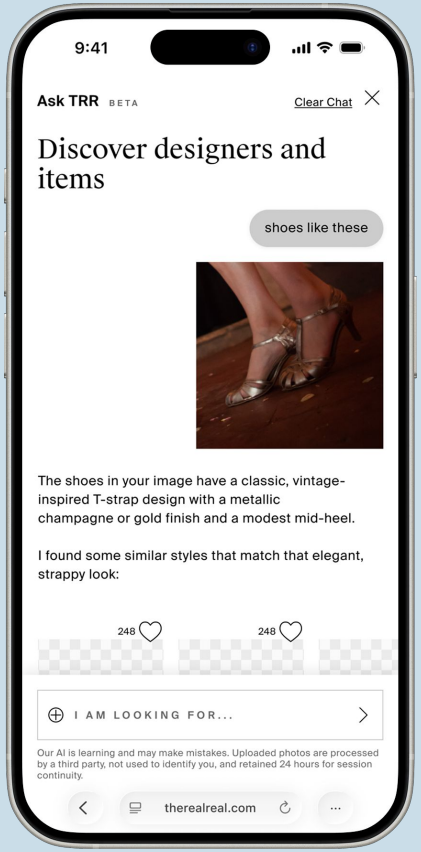


Results

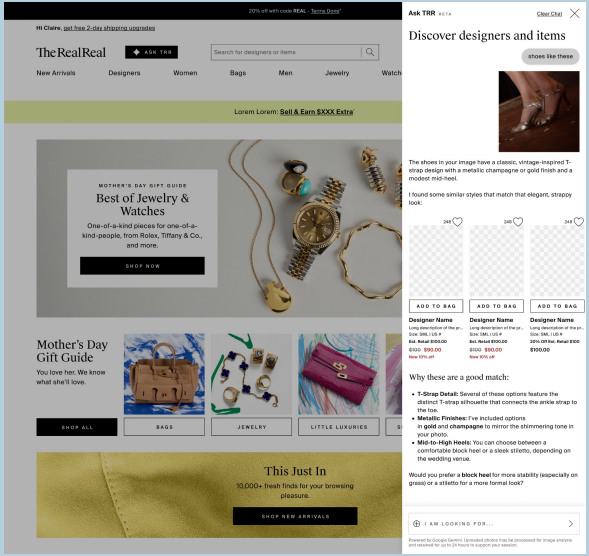
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Mobile Web

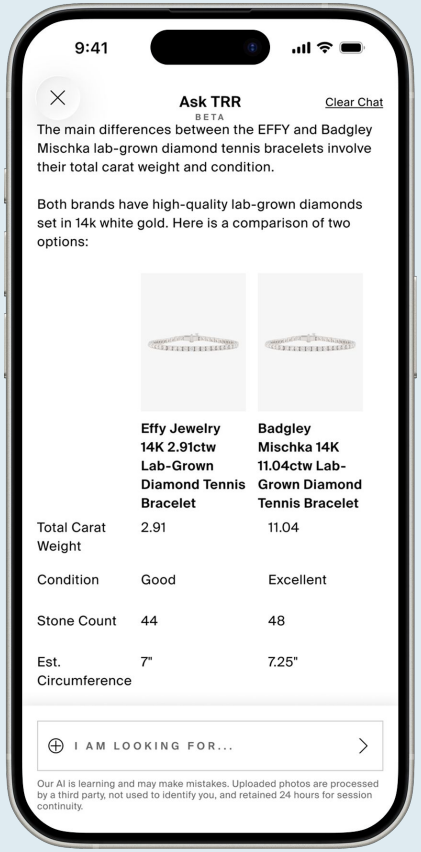


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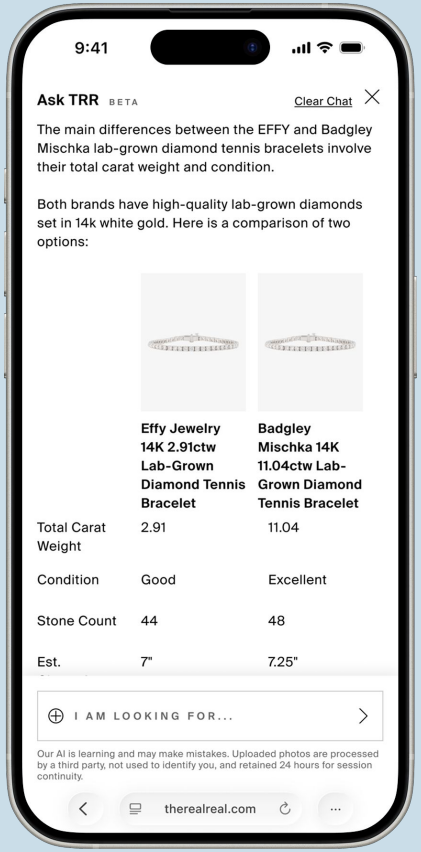


Compare Products

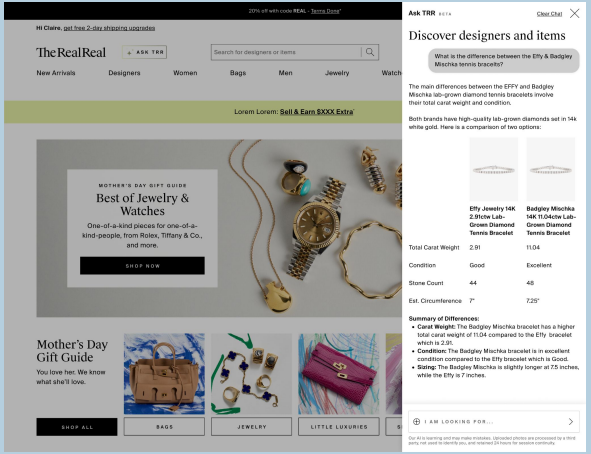
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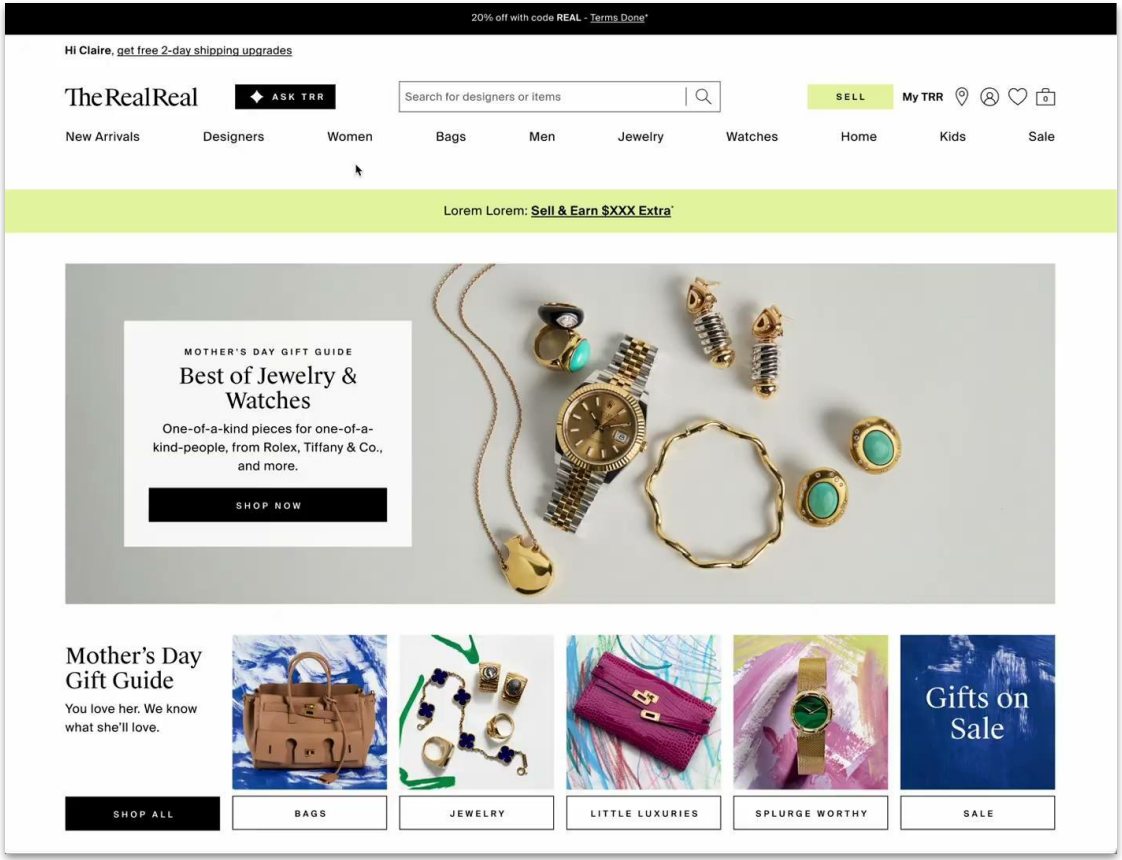
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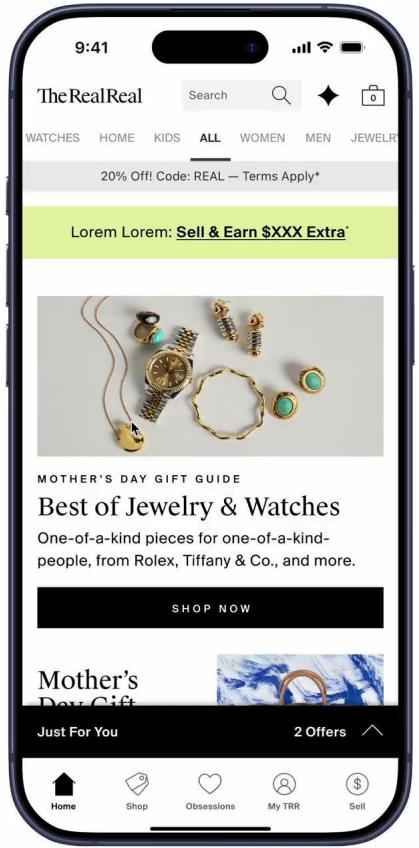
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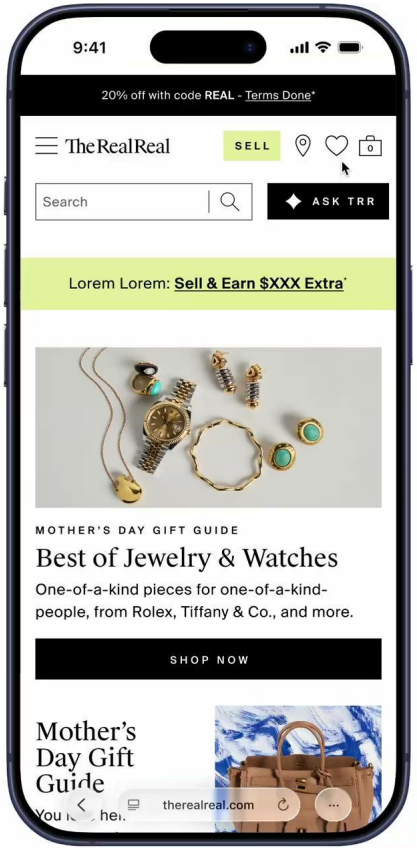
Desktop


20% off with code REAL - Terms Done*
Hi Claire, get free 2-day shipping upgrades
The RealReal
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SELL
My TRR
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Men
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Thank You!